

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Chicago police Officer Krystal Rivera remembered at funeral as someone fiercely devoted to serving and protecting others



FOREVER 'A HERO'

By Caroline Kubzansky and Sam Charles | Chicago Tribune

Mourners, elected officials and police officers from across the state gathered in the near west suburbs Wednesday for the funeral of Chicago police Officer Krystal Rivera, who was remembered as a woman of faith fiercely loyal to her family and a caring friend.

The ceremony for Rivera 36, mistakenly shot and killed by her partner, was the first held this year for a CPD officer killed in the line of duty.

Among the first to eulogize Rivera was CPD Superintendent Larry Snelling, who was present at the hospital and spoke with the officer's family the night she died. Snelling remembered how Rivera's 10-year-old daughter, Isabella, asked him that night, "Was my mom a good police officer?"

"She was, she is and she always will be a hero to everyone here," Snelling said to mourners. "Her name will not be forgotten. She gave everything to

help other people. What a noble thing from a noble person."

Snelling added that, in August 2024, Rivera received a Lifesaving Award for aid she gave a citizen who was "catastrophically injured."

"In taking on a job like this ... you understand the risks of the job, and yet you choose to do it anyway," Snelling said. "You know that every day that you go out into the street, with all of the unpredictability of policing, there's a strong possibility that you may never return home. And yet she did it anyway. She made a difference in this city."

Rivera was born and raised in the Humboldt Park neighborhood and, at an early age, saw a future in law enforcement, Police Department Chaplain Kimberly Lewis-Davis told attendees.

"She had a contagious sense of

Turn to Rivera, Page 5

Bella Medina, daughter of Chicago police Officer Krystal Rivera, is presented with the Chicago casket flag by police Superintendent Larry Snelling at Rivera's funeral at Living Word Christian Center in Forest Park on Wednesday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

NATO allies up spending on defense

Trump casts vote as 'big win' for US, reaffirms commitment to group after years of complaints

By Seung Min Kim
and Darlene Superville
Associated Press

THE HAGUE, Netherlands — President Donald Trump on Wednesday wrapped up participation in the annual NATO summit, a gathering notable this year for an atmosphere that was far chummier toward Trump than the tension-filled meetings of his first term.

After less than 24 hours on the ground in the Netherlands, the Republican president headed back to Washington having secured a major policy change he has pushed for since 2017: Most NATO countries, except Spain, agreed to significantly increase their defense spending.

The president also affirmed his commitment to NATO's mutual defense pledge on Wednesday, a day after he rattled the 32-nation alliance by sounding noncommittal about the pact.

Trump cast the defense spending vote as a "big win" for the

United States and the world and said the boost will add more than \$1 trillion annually to "our common defense."

"This is a monument, really, to victory, but it's a monumental win for the United States," the president said at a closing news conference at The Hague. "This is a big win for Europe and, actually, for Western civilization."

Before taking reporters' questions, Trump sought to ease concerns by reaffirming that he abides by Article 5 of the NATO treaty, the mutual defense pact that treats an attack on one member as an attack on all.

Asked to clarify his stance as he met with Dutch Prime Minister Dick Schoof, Trump said, "I stand with it. That's why I'm here. If I didn't stand with it, I wouldn't be here."

He had mused just a day earlier that whether he abides by the treaty "depends on your definition" of Article 5.

Turn to NATO, Page 9



Lisa Fleischmann heads into the McHenry County Government Center on Tuesday in Woodstock. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Faced with eviction, Trump store owner to vacate building

Woman accused of violating Huntley sign laws blames municipal swamp, pledges to reopen

By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

The owner of a controversial Trump-themed store facing eviction in Chicago's northwest suburbs has agreed to move out of the building next month as part of a settlement agreement with the landlord filed Wednesday in McHenry County Circuit Court.

Yet Lisa Fleischmann of the Trump Truth Store in Huntley said she hasn't given up her vision for a local shop dedicated to making America great again: The entrepreneur said she hopes to soon relocate to a new space in a nearby suburb, preferably one

with more square footage.

"People want to know the truth; they support my fight," said Fleischmann, who appeared in court wearing a black tube top reading "45-47 Take America back," sandals decorated with a copy of President Donald Trump's signature and a faux crystal "Trump" choker with an American flag. "The people of Huntley definitely support what I'm doing," she said. "I'm like a celebrity whenever I go out to any of these functions. It's insane."

Her store was accused of violating Huntley building and sign ordinances, partially

Turn to Store, Page 5

Pizza royalty returns to North Side, as idiosyncratic as ever

By Christopher Borrelli
Chicago Tribune

Great Lake, the legendary (and legendarily iconoclastic) pizza joint that fixated (and sometimes frustrated) Andersonville for five years, has returned, a dozen years later.

Last week, in true Great Lake fashion, it opened very quietly on

Berwyn Avenue, two blocks from its original home on Balmoral Avenue. Already, it's remarkable: It opened without an online footprint, blip of social media, publicity campaign to herald its return, or much of a storefront sign to direct you. Lydia Esparza, who co-founded Great Lake with husband Nick Lessins, told me she was still trying to figure out what

Reddit meant.

When I visited on a late afternoon, she looked at me and laughed:

I was the fifth customer of the day.

Forty-eight hours later, on a weekday morning, an excited neighbor in a Chicago cap, from down the street, poked his head in and asked: *Was it really true? Were*

they back? He asked because he was the only one there at 10 a.m. and the vibes this time were ...

Relaxed?

That's a big difference from those days of long queues down Balmoral, the national spotlight (GQ, Food & Wine, New York Times, etc.) that said Great Lake made the best pizza in America, the block-long lines during

a one-day pop-up at Cellar Door Provisions in 2019, that crush of fans suggesting Great Lake had not faded from memories. Anyone who went to Great Lake, which lasted from 2008 to 2013, can recall a story: Three-hour waits for pizzas, life-changing pizzas, sitting shoulder to shoulder with

Turn to Pizza, Page 4

TODAY'S
WEATHER



High 94 Low 74

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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